



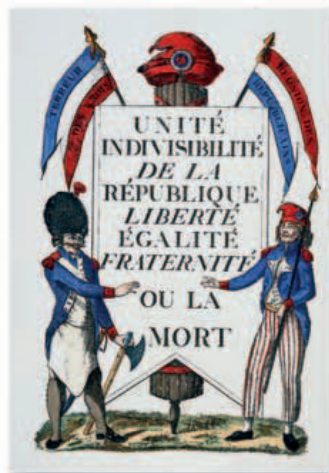
General Josiah Harmar met with defeat when he mounted a campaign against a coalition of American Indians in the Northwest Territory.

NEWS OF THE EVENTS IN PARIS

spread to French colonies. As the National Assembly knew, **slavery** did not sit well with the ideas espoused in the *Declaration of the Rights of Man*. Neither did the inequity that **free people of color** faced in France and its empire.

Part of the French Empire was Saint-Domingue (Haiti), half of the island of Hispaniola—the other half of the island, Santo Domingo (Dominican Republic), belonged to Spain. In 1790, two wealthy mixed-race planters from Saint-Domingue, **Vincent Ogé** (1750–91) and **Julien Raimond** (1744–1801) were in Paris, where they argued that because they were property owners, they ought to be given full rights. Ogé was frustrated by the Assembly's failure to confront white planters on this issue and continued his protest back in Saint-Domingue. He led a **revolt** of some 200 supporters in the town of Grande-Rivière. It was quickly suppressed, and Ogé fled to Santo Domingo.

Throughout 1790, the National Assembly continued working on a **constitution**, pushing through the official ban on the nobility and suppressing the **religious orders**.



Revolutionary cartoon

This illustration shows a version of the French Revolutionary emblem issuing the famous call for liberty, equality, and fraternity or death.

In the US, General Josiah Harmar (1753–1813) had been ambushed by a coalition of American Indians. The attack near the Maumee River (Ohio) in the **Northwest Territory** was led by **Chief Little Turtle** (1752–1812). Harmar was ordered to lead an expedition against the Indians, but his force of 1,100 militiamen and 320 troops was forced to **retreat**.

“MEN ARE BORN AND REMAIN FREE AND IN EQUAL RIGHTS. SOCIAL DISTINCTIONS MAY BE FOUNDED ONLY UPON THE GENERAL GOOD.”

Article 1, *Declaration of the Rights of Man and of the Citizen*, 1789



Plantations go up in flames in Le Cap in the north of Saint-Domingue (Haiti) during the slave rebellion.

IN JANUARY, VINCENT OGÉ and **Jean-Baptiste Chavannes** (c. 1748–1791), who had helped Ogé organize the 1790 revolt, were in hiding in the Spanish colony, Santo Domingo. They were, however, returned by the Spanish to Saint-Domingue, where their bones were broken on a wheel and their **heads placed on stakes**. This was met with outrage in France, and by May political rights were granted to free people of color, if born of two free parents.

Slaves in Saint-Domingue had also been hearing a mixture of news and rumors about events in Paris and begun to hope they would see abolition. In the end, they decided not to wait for France to grant it to them.

One hot August evening, a slave leader named **Dutty Boukman** (?–1791) gathered slaves at a religious voodoo ceremony in Bois-Caïman and told them to “listen to the voice of liberty that



Slaves vs. settlers

The high number of slaves imported to Saint-Domingue to work in the sugar industry became a liability when they launched a rebellion.

speaks in all of us.” A week later, Boukman and his followers launched a **massive revolt** in the north of the island. They attacked estates, killed slave owners, destroyed tools, and torched cane fields. They had numbers on their side: the slave population in Saint-Domingue was more than



Haitian revolution

The slave revolt in French Saint-Domingue later became an international conflict when Britain and Spain went to war with France.

15 times the population of whites. Unlike previous revolts, this one would prove **unstoppable**.

In France, Louis XVI and his family had tried to **flee** to the royalist stronghold of Montmédy on the eastern border. They reached **Varennes**, in the northeast of the country, before being stopped and forcibly returned to Paris. After this failed attempt at escape, Louis lost all credibility as a monarch.

VOODOO AND SAINT-DOMINGUE

Haitian Voodoo (or Voudou) is a religion that was born out of slavery. It draws on a range of African traditions, especially those of Benin, the former home of many slaves. It also incorporates Catholicism, the religion forced on the slaves by their captors, and may also have links to the practices of the indigenous Arawak people. The Catholic practices slaves adopted enabled them to disguise their true religion from their masters, with Catholic saints standing in for *Loa* (spirits) worshiped in Voodoo. This new system of belief allowed slaves to form their own identity and also provided a way of organizing resistance, as in Saint-Domingue.

Third Anglo-Mysore War (to 1792) leads to the defeat of Tipu Sultan (1750–99)

October Vincent Ogé and Jean-Baptiste Chavannes lead first revolt in France's Saint-Domingue

August 14 Russo-Swedish War ends with Treaty of Värälä

The monumental Brandenburg Gate in Berlin is finished

August 20 Danish navigator Vitus Jonas Bering discovers Alaska

March 2 Semaphore telegraph demonstrated in France

June 21 Louis XVI and the royal family attempt to flee Paris

The Constitutional Act splits Canada into Upper and Lower Canada

August 21 Large-scale slave uprising begins in Saint-Domingue

September 30 Premiere of Mozart's opera *The Magic Flute* in Vienna

December 5 Austrian composer Wolfgang Amadeus Mozart (b. 1756) dies